SURVIVAL-TIPS

Disaster Risk Reduction (DRR)

Risk awareness, emergency preparedness, first aid, shelter, evacuation, and immediate survival.

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How to use this handbook

Use this guide as a learning aid, not as a substitute for official emergency instructions or expert assessment. Every AI-extracted tip must be reviewed before it is treated as verified guidance. Never infer that a wild plant, mushroom, water source, or improvised material is safe based on appearance alone.

1. Use Local, Sustainable Materials

Prioritize locally sourced, sustainably harvested materials for shelter construction to reduce transport costs, environmental impact, and support local economies.

Steps

1. Identify available local materials (wood, sand, etc.).
2. Assess sustainability and environmental impact.
3. Source materials responsibly.
4. Incorporate into shelter design.

Warnings

• Overharvesting can damage local ecosystems.

• Unsustainable sourcing may increase costs.

Review status: needs_review • Category: other

Source: Emergency Shelter Solutions and Standards | UNHCR — https://emergency.unhcr.org/emergency-assistance/settlement-and-shelter/guidance-shelter/emergency-shelter-solutions-and-standards

2. Employ Plastic Sheeting as Primary Shelter Component

Use lightweight, UV-resistant plastic sheeting as the main covering for shelters, combined with rigid framing for flexibility and cost-effectiveness.

Steps

1. Acquire sufficient plastic sheeting.
2. Attach to framing or skeleton.
3. Seal edges with tape or staples.

Warnings

• Not wind-resistant; may fail in heavy rain or high winds.

• Improper disposal can harm the environment.

Review status: needs_review • Category: other

Source: Emergency Shelter Solutions and Standards | UNHCR — https://emergency.unhcr.org/emergency-assistance/settlement-and-shelter/guidance-shelter/emergency-shelter-solutions-and-standards

3. Adhere to Minimum Covered Living Space Standards

Ensure shelters provide at least 3.5 m² per person in warm climates and 4.5–5.5 m² per person in cold climates to prevent overcrowding and maintain comfort.

Steps

1. Calculate required area per person.
2. Design shelter layout accordingly.
3. Verify compliance before occupancy.

Warnings

• Insufficient space leads to overcrowding and health risks.

Review status: needs_review • Category: other

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4. Maintain Minimum Shelter Height for Ventilation

Design shelters with a minimum of 2 m height at the lowest point to promote air circulation and reduce heat loss.

Steps

1. Set roof height to at least 2 m.
2. Ensure clearance for occupants and ventilation.
3. Adjust design for local climate if needed.

Warnings

• Low height reduces airflow and can cause condensation.

Review status: needs_review • Category: other

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5. Insulate and Seal Shelters in Cold Climates

Use plastic sheeting, tapes, and insulation on walls, roofs, and doors to retain heat and reduce wind and snow penetration.

Steps

1. Seal windows and doors with plastic sheeting and tape.
2. Insulate walls, ceilings, and floors.
3. Check for gaps and seal them.

Warnings

• Improper sealing can lead to fire hazards if heating sources are used.

• Insulation must be fire■rated.

Review status: needs_review • Category: other

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